

PLANK

Kumbhakasana

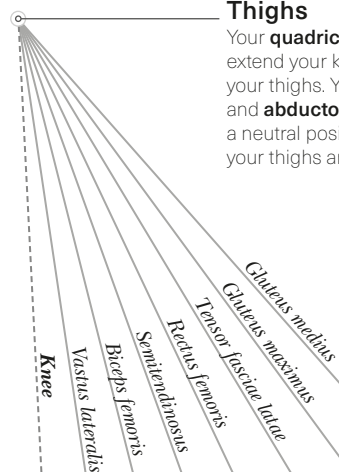
Plank pose is the top point of a press up. It is a strong, stabilizing pose that works muscles from the deepest layers inside you to the most superficial. When holding Plank you are giving your body a thorough, strengthening workout.

THE BIG PICTURE

Plank pose particularly strengthens your shoulders and entire core—including your abdominals, back muscles, and pelvic floor muscles. It builds heat and energy throughout your body when held for several breaths or more.

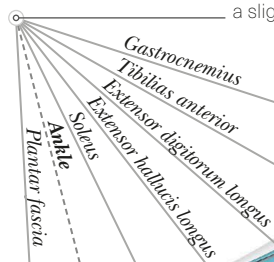
Thighs

Your **quadriceps** engage to extend your knees and stabilize your thighs. Your **hip adductors** and **abductors** engage while in a neutral position to stabilize your thighs and hips.



Lower legs

Your **ankle dorsiflexors** engage as you press your heels back. You are likely to feel a stretch in your **toe flexors** and in the plantar region of your foot. Your **calf muscles** are in a slightly stretched position.



KEY

•-- Joints

○ Muscles

● Engaging

● Engaging while stretching

● Stretching

VARIATION

Place your forearms and, optionally, knees down to lower the intensity. Don't allow your back to sag—if you feel any strain on your back come out of the pose and rest.

